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United States Patent	12405696
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
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No-ground plane differential touch screen display

Abstract

A no-ground plane differential touch screen display includes a display, a plurality of differential electrode pairs integrated into the display, a plurality of differential drive-sense circuits, and a processing module. When enabled, a set of differential drive-sense circuits of the plurality of differential drive-sense circuits is operable to provide a set of differential electrode signals to a set of differential electrode pairs of the plurality of differential electrode pairs and generate a set of sensed signals representative of electrical characteristic changes of the set of differential electrode pairs. The processing module is operable to interpret the electrical characteristic changes as one or more of a column mutual capacitance of a column differential electrode pair, a row mutual capacitance of a row differential electrode pair, and a cross mutual capacitance at a crossing between one or more row differential electrode pairs and column differential electrode pairs.

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Appl. No.:	18/825403
Filed:	September 05, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240427464 A1	Dec. 26, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 18214722 20230627 US 12093495 child-doc US 18825403
continuation parent-doc US 17820499 20220817 US 11733820 20230822 child-doc US 18214722

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06F3/044 (20060101); G06F3/041 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G06F3/0446 (20190501); G06F3/0412 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06F (3/04166); G06F (3/0412); G06F (3/0446); G06F (3/0448)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present U.S. Utility Patent Application claims priority pursuant to 35 U.S.C. § 120 as a continuation of U.S. Utility application Ser. No. 18/214,722, entitled “NO-GROUND PLANE DIFFERENTIAL TOUCH SCREEN DISPLAY”, filed Jun. 27, 2023, which claims priority pursuant to 35 U.S.C. § 120 as a continuation of U.S. Utility application Ser. No. 17/820,499, entitled “DIFFERENTIAL TOUCH SCREEN DISPLAY SIGNAL PROCESSING,” filed Aug. 17, 2022, issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,733,820 on Aug. 22, 2023, which claims priority pursuant to 35 U.S.C. § 120 as a continuation of U.S. Utility application Ser. No. 17/449,228, entitled “DIFFERENTIAL TOUCH SCREEN DISPLAY,” filed Sep. 28, 2021, issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,435,864 on Sep. 6, 2022, all of which are hereby incorporated herein by reference in their entirety and made part of the present U.S. Utility Patent Application for all purposes.

STATEMENT REGARDING FEDERALLY SPONSORED RESEARCH OR DEVELOPMENT

(1) Not Applicable.

INCORPORATION-BY-REFERENCE OF MATERIAL SUBMITTED ON A COMPACT DISC

(2) Not Applicable.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Technical Field of the Invention

(3) This disclosure relates generally to data communication systems and more particularly to sensed data collection and/or communication.

Description of Related Art

(4) Sensors are used in a wide variety of applications ranging from in-home automation, to industrial systems, to health care, to transportation, and so on. For example, sensors are placed in bodies, automobiles, airplanes, boats, ships, trucks, motorcycles, cell phones, televisions, touch-screens, industrial plants, appliances, motors, checkout counters, etc. for the variety of applications.

(5) In general, a sensor converts a physical quantity into an electrical or optical signal. For example, a sensor converts a physical phenomenon, such as a biological condition, a chemical condition, an electric condition, an electromagnetic condition, a temperature, a magnetic condition, mechanical motion (position, velocity, acceleration, force, pressure), an optical condition, and/or a radioactivity condition, into an electrical signal.

(6) A sensor includes a transducer, which functions to convert one form of energy (e.g., force) into another form of energy (e.g., electrical signal). There are a variety of transducers to support the various applications of sensors. For example, a transducer is capacitor, a piezoelectric transducer, a piezoresistive transducer, a thermal transducer, a thermal-couple, a photoconductive transducer such as a photoresistor, a photodiode, and/or phototransistor.

(7) A sensor circuit is coupled to a sensor to provide the sensor with power and to receive the signal representing the physical phenomenon from the sensor. The sensor circuit includes at least three electrical connections to the sensor: one for a power supply; another for a common voltage reference (e.g., ground); and a third for receiving the signal representing the physical phenomenon.

The signal representing the physical phenomenon will vary from the power supply voltage to ground as the physical phenomenon changes from one extreme to another (for the range of sensing the physical phenomenon).

(8) The sensor circuits provide the received sensor signals to one or more computing devices for processing. A computing device is known to communicate data, process data, and/or store data. The computing device may be a cellular phone, a laptop, a tablet, a personal computer (PC), a work station, a video game device, a server, and/or a data center that support millions of web searches, stock trades, or on-line purchases every hour.

(9) The computing device processes the sensor signals for a variety of applications. For example, the computing device processes sensor signals to determine temperatures of a variety of items in a refrigerated truck during transit. As another example, the computing device processes the sensor signals to determine a touch on a touch screen. As yet another example, the computing device processes the sensor signals to determine various data points in a production line of a product.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWING(S)

- (1) FIG. 1 is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a differential touch screen computing device;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a differential touch screen display;
- (3) FIG. 3 is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a drive-sense circuit (DSC);
- (4) FIG. 4 is an example graph that plots condition verses capacitance for an electrode of a touch screen display having drive-sense circuits (DSC) coupled to electrodes;
- (5) FIG. 5 is an example graph that plots impedance verses frequency for an electrode of a touch screen display having drive-sense circuits (DSCs) coupled to electrodes;
- (6) FIG. 6 is a time domain example graph that plots magnitude verses time for an analog reference signal;
- (7) FIG. 7 is a frequency domain example graph that plots magnitude verses frequency for an analog reference signal;
- (8) FIG. 8 is a schematic block diagram of an example of a first drive-sense circuit coupled to a first electrode and a second drive-sense circuit coupled to a second electrode;
- (9) FIG. 9 is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC);
- (10) FIG. 10 is a schematic block diagram of another embodiment of a differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC);
- (11) FIGS. 11A-11B are schematic block diagrams of examples of mutual capacitance electric fields of differential electrode pairs;
- (12) FIG. 12 is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a differential touch screen display;
- (13) FIGS. 13A-13B are schematic block diagrams of embodiments of a plurality of electrodes creating a plurality of touch sense cells within a touch screen display;
- (14) FIGS. 14A-14D are schematic block diagrams of embodiments of touch screen electrode patterns;
- (15) FIG. 15 is a schematic block diagram of an example of a first differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) coupled to a column differential pair of electrodes and a third differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) coupled to a row differential pair of electrodes;
- (16) FIG. 15A is a schematic block diagram of another example of a first differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) coupled to a column differential pair of electrodes and a third differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) coupled to a row differential pair of electrodes;

- (17) FIG. **15B** is a schematic block diagram of another example of a first differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) coupled to a column differential pair of electrodes and a third differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) coupled to a row differential pair of electrodes;
- (18) FIG. **16** is a schematic block diagram of a touchless example of a few differential drive-sense circuits and a portion of the touch screen processing module of a differential touch screen display;
- (19) FIG. **17** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display;
- (20) FIG. **18** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display;
- (21) FIG. **19** is a schematic block diagram of an example of column differential drive-sense circuits and a portion of the touch screen processing module of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display;
- (22) FIG. **20** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display;
- (23) FIGS. **21A-21B** are schematic block diagrams of embodiments of differential drive-sense circuits and a portion of the touch screen processing module of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display;
- (24) FIG. **22** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display;
- (25) FIG. **23** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC);
- (26) FIG. **24** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a differential touch screen display;
- (27) FIG. **25** is a schematic block diagram of another embodiment of a portion of a differential touch screen display; and
- (28) FIG. **26** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of differential drive-sense circuits and a portion of the touch screen processing module of a differential touch screen display.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

- (29) FIG. **1** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a differential touch screen computing device **10**. The differential touch screen computing device **10** includes a differential touch screen **12**, a core control module **14**, one or more processing modules **16**, one or more main memories **18**, cache memory **20**, a video graphics processing module **22**, a display **24**, an Input-Output (I/O) peripheral control module **26**, one or more input/output (I/O) interface modules **28**, one or more network interface modules **30**, and one or more memory interface modules **32**. A processing module **16** is described in greater detail at the end of the detailed description of the invention section and, in an alternative embodiment, has a direction connection to the main memory **18**. In an alternate embodiment, the core control module **14** and the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26** are one module, such as a chipset, a quick path interconnect (QPI), and/or an ultra-path interconnect (UPI).
- (30) The differential touch screen **12** includes a differential touch screen display, a plurality of differential sensor pairs, a plurality of differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs), and a touch screen processing module **34**. In general, the differential sensor pairs (e.g., differential electrode pairs, differential capacitor sensing cell pairs, differential capacitor sensors pairs, differential inductive sensor pairs, etc.) detect a proximal touch of the screen. For example, when one or more fingers touches the screen, capacitance of differential sensor pairs proximal to the touch(es) are affected (e.g., impedance changes). The differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) coupled to affected differential sensor pairs detect the change and provide a representation of the change to the touch screen processing module **34**, which may be a separate processing module or integrated into the processing module **16**.
- (31) In comparison to drive-sense circuits (DSCs) coupled to single sensors, the DDSCs are more

sensitive to small changes and reduce noise and power of the differential touch screen computing device. A DDSC will be discussed in more detail with reference to FIG. 9.

(32) The touch screen processing module **34** processes the representative signals from the differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) to determine the location of the touch(es). This information is inputted to the processing module **16** for processing as an input. For example, a touch represents a selection of a button on screen, a scroll function, a zoom in-out function, etc.

(33) Each of the main memories **18** includes one or more Random Access Memory (RAM) integrated circuits, or chips. For example, a main memory **18** includes four DDR4 (4^{sup}.th generation of double data rate) RAM chips, each running at a rate of 2,400 MHz. In general, the main memory **18** stores data and operational instructions most relevant for the processing module **16**. For example, the core control module **14** coordinates the transfer of data and/or operational instructions from the main memory **18** and the memory **36-38**. The data and/or operational instructions retrieve from memory **36-38** are the data and/or operational instructions requested by the processing module or will most likely be needed by the processing module. When the processing module is done with the data and/or operational instructions in main memory, the core control module **14** coordinates sending updated data to the memory **36-38** for storage.

(34) The memory **36-38** includes one or more hard drives, one or more solid state memory chips, and/or one or more other large capacity storage devices that, in comparison to cache memory and main memory devices, is/are relatively inexpensive with respect to cost per amount of data stored. The memory **36-38** is coupled to the core control module **14** via the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26** and via one or more memory interface modules **32**. In an embodiment, the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26** includes one or more Peripheral Component Interface (PCI) buses to which peripheral components connect to the core control module **14**. A memory interface module **32** includes a software driver and a hardware connector for coupling a memory device to the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26**. For example, a memory interface **32** is in accordance with a Serial Advanced Technology Attachment (SATA) port.

(35) The core control module **14** coordinates data communications between the processing module(s) **16** and network(s) via the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26**, the network interface module(s) **30**, and a network card **40** or **42**. The network(s) includes one more local area networks (LAN) and/or one or more wide area networks (WAN), which may be a public network and/or a private network. A LAN may be a wireless-LAN (e.g., Wi-Fi access point, Bluetooth, ZigBee, etc.) and/or a wired network (e.g., Firewire, Ethernet, etc.). A WAN may be a wired and/or wireless WAN. For example, a LAN may be a personal home or business's wireless network and a WAN is the Internet, cellular telephone infrastructure, and/or satellite communication infrastructure.

(36) A network card **40** or **42** includes a wireless communication unit or a wired communication unit. A wireless communication unit includes a wireless local area network (WLAN) communication device, a cellular communication device, a Bluetooth device, and/or a ZigBee communication device. A wired communication unit includes a Gigabit LAN connection, a Firewire connection, and/or a proprietary computer wired connection. A network interface module **30** includes a software driver and a hardware connector for coupling the network card to the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26**. For example, the network interface module **60** is in accordance with one or more versions of IEEE 802.11, cellular telephone protocols, 10/100/1000 Gigabit LAN protocols, etc.

(37) The core control module **14** coordinates data communications between the processing module(s) **16** and input device(s) via the I/O interface module(s) **28** and the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26**. An input device includes a keypad, a keyboard, control switches, a touchpad, a microphone, a camera, etc. An I/O interface module **28** includes a software driver and a hardware connector for coupling an input device to the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26**. In an embodiment, an I/O interface module **28** is in accordance with one or more Universal Serial Bus (USB) protocols.

(38) The core control module **14** coordinates data communications between the processing module(s) **16** and output device(s) via the I/O interface module(s) **28** and the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26**. An output device includes a speaker, etc. An I/O interface module **26** includes a software driver and a hardware connector for coupling an output device to the I/O and/or peripheral control module **26**. In an embodiment, an I/O interface module **28** is in accordance with one or more audio codec protocols.

(39) The processing module **16** communicates directly with a video graphics processing module **22** to display data on the display **24**. The display **24** includes an LED (light emitting diode) display, an LCD (liquid crystal display), and/or other type of display technology. The display **24** has a resolution, an aspect ratio, and other features that affect the quality of the display **24**. The video graphics processing module **22** receives data from the processing module **16**, processes the data to produce rendered data in accordance with the characteristics of the display **24**, and provides the rendered data to the display **24**.

(40) FIG. 2 is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a differential touch screen display **44** that includes a plurality of differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs), a touch screen processing module **56**, a display **52**, a plurality of row differential electrode pairs **54-r**, and a plurality of column differential electrode pairs **54-c**. The differential touch screen display **44** is coupled to a processing module **16**, a video graphics processing module **22**, and a display interface **50**, which are components of a computing device (e.g., differential touch screen computing device **10**), an interactive display, or other device that includes a differential touch screen display. An interactive display functions to provide users with an interactive experience (e.g., touch the screen to obtain information, be entertained, etc.). For example, a store provides interactive displays for customers to find certain products, to obtain coupons, to enter contests, etc.

(41) There are a variety of other devices that include a touch screen display. For example, a vending machine includes a touch screen display to select and/or pay for an item. As another example of a device having a touch screen display is an Automated Teller Machine (ATM). As yet another example, an automobile includes a touch screen display for entertainment media control, navigation, climate control, etc.

(42) The differential touch screen display **44** may include a large display **52** that has a resolution equal to or greater than full high-definition (HD), an aspect ratio of a set of aspect ratios, and a screen size equal to or greater than thirty-two inches. The following table lists various combinations of resolution, aspect ratio, and screen size for the display **52**, but it is not an exhaustive list.

(43) TABLE-US-00001

Width	Height	pixel aspect ratio	screen size (inches)	Resolution (lines)	(lines) ratio aspect
1280	720	1:1	16:9	32, 40, 43, 50, 55, 60, 65, definition)	70, 75, &/or >80
1920	1080	1:1	16:9	32, 40, 43, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, 75, &/or >80	HD 960
720	4:3	16:9	32, 40, 43, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, 75, &/or >80	HD 1440	1080 4:3 16:9 32, 40, 43, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, 75, &/or >80
1280	1080	3:2	16:9	32, 40, 43, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, 75, &/or >80	QHD (quad 2560
1440	1:1	16:9	32, 40, 43, 50, 55, 60, 65, HD)	70, 75, &/or >80	UHD (Ultra 3840
2160	1:1	16:9	32, 40, 43, 50, 55, 60, 65, HD)	or 4K 70, 75, &/or >80	8K 7680
4320	1:1	16:9	32, 40, 43, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, 75, &/or >80	HD and 1280-=>7680	720-=>4320 1:1, 2:3, etc. 2:3 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, 75, above &/or >80

(44) The display **52** is one of a variety of types of displays that is operable to render frames of data into visible images. For example, the display is one or more of: a light emitting diode (LED) display, an electroluminescent display (ELD), a plasma display panel (PDP), a liquid crystal display (LCD), an LCD high performance addressing (HPA) display, an LCD thin film transistor (TFT) display, an organic light emitting diode (OLED) display, a digital light processing (DLP) display, a surface conductive electron emitter (SED) display, a field emission display (FED), a laser TV display, a carbon nanotubes display, a quantum dot display, an interferometric modulator display (IMOD), and a digital microshutter display (DMS). The display is active in a full display

mode or a multiplexed display mode (i.e., only part of the display is active at a time).

(45) The display **52** further includes integrated differential electrode pairs **54** that provide the sensors for the touch sense part of the touch screen display. The differential electrode pairs **54** are distributed throughout the display area or where touch screen functionality is desired. For example, a first group of the differential electrode pairs are arranged in rows and a second group of differential electrode pairs are arranged in columns. As will be discussed in greater detail with reference to one or more of the following Figures, the row differential electrode pairs are separated from the column differential electrode pairs by a dielectric material. As compared to an electrode coupled to a drive-sense circuit (DSC), a differential electrode pair coupled to a differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC), is more sensitive to proximal touches and/or hovers due to increased mutual capacitance and decreased common mode noise. The electrode coupled to a drive-sense circuit (DSC) will be discussed in greater detail with reference to FIG. **3**. The differential electrode pair coupled to a differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) will be discussed in greater detail with reference to FIG. **9**.

(46) The electrodes **54** are comprised of a transparent conductive material and are in-cell or on-cell with respect to layers of the display. For example, a conductive trace is placed in-cell or on-cell of a layer of the touch screen display. The transparent conductive material, which is substantially transparent and has negligible effect on video quality of the display with respect to the human eye. For instance, an electrode is constructed from one or more of: Indium Tin Oxide, Graphene, Carbon Nanotubes, Thin Metal Films, Silver Nanowires Hybrid Materials, Aluminum-doped Zinc Oxide (AZO), Amorphous Indium-Zinc Oxide, Gallium-doped Zinc Oxide (GZO), and poly polystyrene sulfonate (PEDOT).

(47) In an example of operation, the processing module **16** is executing an operating system application **58** and one or more user applications **48**. The user applications **48** include, but are not limited to, a video playback application, a spreadsheet application, a word processing application, a computer aided drawing application, a photo display application, an image processing application, a database application, etc. While executing an application **48**, the processing module generates data for display (e.g., video data, image data, text data, etc.). The processing module **16** sends the data to the video graphics processing module **22**, which converts the data into frames of video **46** (i.e., data).

(48) The video graphics processing module **22** sends the frames of video **46** (e.g., frames of a video file, refresh rate for a word processing document, a series of images, etc.) to the display interface **50**. The display interface **50** provides the frames of video to the display **52**, which renders the frames of video into visible images.

(49) While the display **52** is rendering the frames of video into visible images, the differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) provide differential electrode signals to the differential electrode pairs **54**. When the screen is touched, capacitance of the electrodes **54** proximal to the touch (i.e., directly or close by (e.g., a hover)) is changed. The DDSCs detect the capacitance change for affected electrodes and provide the detected change to the touch screen processing module **56**.

(50) The touch screen processing module **56** processes the capacitance change of the affected electrodes to determine one or more specific locations of touch and provides this information to the processing module **16**. The processing module **16** processes the one or more specific locations of touch to determine if an operation of the application is to be altered. For example, the touch is indicative of a pause command, a fast forward command, a reverse command, an increase volume command, a decrease volume command, a stop command, a select command, a delete command, etc. In another embodiment, the processing module **16** also operates as the touch screen processing module **56**.

(51) FIG. **3** is a schematic block diagram an embodiment of a drive-sense circuit (DSC) **60** coupled to an electrode **54** that includes a first conversion circuit **62** and a second conversion circuit **64**. The first conversion circuit **62** includes comparator (comp) **66** and an analog to digital converter (ADC)

68. The second conversion circuit **64** includes a digital to analog converter (DAC) **70**, a signal source circuit **72**, and a driver **74**.

(52) The analog to digital converter (ADC) **68** may be implemented in a variety of ways. For example, the ADC **68** is one of: a flash ADC, a successive approximation ADC, a ramp-compare ADC, a Wilkinson ADC, an integrating ADC, a delta encoded ADC, and/or a sigma-delta ADC. The digital to analog converter (DAC) **70** may be a sigma-delta DAC, a pulse width modulator DAC, a binary weighted DAC, a successive approximation DAC, and/or a thermometer-coded DAC.

(53) The feedback loop of the drive-sense circuit **60** functions to keep an electrode signal **76** substantially matching an analog reference signal **78**. As such, the electrode signal **76** will have a similar waveform to that of the analog reference signal **78**. The first conversion circuit **62** converts the electrode signal **76** into a sensed signal **84**. The second conversion circuit **64** generates the drive signal component **80** from the sensed signal **84**. As an example, the first and second conversion circuits **62** and **64** function to keep the electrode signal **76** substantially constant (e.g., substantially matching the reference signal **78**) with the first conversion circuit creating the sensed signal **84** to correspond the receive signal component **82** of the electrode signal **76** and the second conversion circuit **64** generating the drive signal component **80** based on adjusting the source signal in accordance with the sensed signal **84**.

(54) In an example, the electrode signal **76** is provided to an electrode **54** as a regulated current signal. The regulated current (I) signal in combination with the impedance (Z) of the electrode **54** creates a voltage (V), where $V=I*Z$. As the impedance (Z) of the electrode **54** changes, the regulated current (I) signal is adjusted to keep the voltage (V) substantially unchanged. To regulate the current signal, the DSC adjusts the drive signal component **80** based on the receive signal component **82** of the sensed signal **84**, which is indicative of the impedance of the electrode **54** and changes thereof.

(55) More specifically, the comparator **66** compares the electrode signal **76** to the analog reference signal **78** to produce an analog comparison signal **86**. The analog comparison signal **86** contains a representation of the drive signal component **80** and the receive signal component **82**. The analog reference signal **78** (e.g., a current signal or a voltage signal) includes a DC component and an oscillating component. The DC component is a DC voltage in the range of a few tens of milli-volts to tens of volts or more. The oscillating component includes a sinusoidal signal, a square wave signal, a triangular wave signal, a multiple level signal (e.g., has varying magnitude over time with respect to the DC component), and/or a polygonal signal (e.g., has a symmetrical or asymmetrical polygonal shape with respect to the DC component). In another example, the frequency of the oscillating component may vary so that it can be tuned to the impedance of the electrode and/or to be off-set in frequency from other electrode signals.

(56) The analog to digital converter **70** converts the analog comparison signal **86** into a digital sensed signal **84** representative of the received signal. In another embodiment, the analog to digital converter **68** and the digital to analog converter **70** are not included and the analog comparison signal **86** is output to the processing module for analysis and analog filtering.

(57) The second conversion circuit **64** adjusts the regulated current based on the changes to the sensed signal **84**. More specifically, the digital to analog converter (DAC) **70** converts the sensed signal **84** into an analog feedback signal **88**. The signal source circuit **72** (e.g., a dependent current source, a linear regulator, a DC-DC power supply, etc.) generates a regulated source signal **90** (e.g., a regulated current signal or a regulated voltage signal) based on the analog feedback signal **88**. The driver **74** increases power of the regulated source signal **90** to produce the drive signal component **80**. Note that, in an embodiment, the driver may be omitted.

(58) As another example, the electrode signal **76** is provided to the electrode **54** as a regulated voltage signal. The regulated voltage (V) signal in combination with the impedance (Z) of the electrode **54** creates an electrode current (I), where $I=V/Z$. As the impedance (Z) of electrode

changes, the regulated voltage (V) signal is adjusted to keep the electrode current (I) substantially unchanged. To regulate the voltage signal, the first conversion circuit **62** adjusts the sensed signal **84** based on the receive signal component **82**, which is indicative of the impedance of the electrode **54** and changes thereof. The second conversion circuit **64** adjusts the regulated voltage based on the changes to the sensed signal **84**.

(59) The digital filtering of the DSC outputted signals can have a very narrow bandwidth (e.g., 100 Hz or less). The combination of low sampling rate, greater than 100 dBm SNR of the DSCs, and very narrow bandwidth allows for very accurate measurements of very low voltage (and/or current) changes of the cells (e.g., of a few nano-volts to tens of pico-volts) in this embodiment and in others.

(60) FIG. 4 is an example graph that plots condition verses capacitance for an electrode of a touch screen display having drive-sense circuits (DSCs) coupled to electrodes as discussed with reference to FIG. 3. As shown, the mutual capacitance decreases with a touch and the self capacitance increases with a touch. Note that the mutual capacitance and self capacitance for a no-touch condition are shown to be about the same. This is done merely for ease of illustration. In practice, the mutual capacitance and self capacitance may or may not be about the same capacitance based on the various properties of the touch screen display discussed above.

(61) FIG. 5 is an example graph that plots impedance verses frequency for an electrode of a touch screen display having drive-sense circuits (DSCs) coupled to electrodes as discussed with reference to FIG. 3. Since the impedance of an electrode is primarily based on its capacitance (self and/or mutual), as the frequency increases for a fixed capacitance, the impedance decreases based on $\frac{1}{2\pi fC}$, where f is the frequency and C is the capacitance.

(62) FIG. 6 is a time domain example graph that plots magnitude verses time for an analog reference signal **78**. As discussed with reference to FIG. 3, the analog reference signal **78** (e.g., a current signal or a voltage signal) is inputted to a comparator and is compared to the electrode signal **76**. The feedback loop of the drive-sense circuit **60** functions to keep the electrode signal **76** substantially matching the analog reference signal **78**. As such, the electrode signal **76** will have a similar waveform to that of the analog reference signal **78**.

(63) In an example, the analog reference signal **78** includes a DC component **92** and/or one or more oscillating components **94**. The DC component **92** is a DC voltage in the range of a few hundred milli-volts to tens of volts or more. The oscillating component **94** includes a sinusoidal signal, a square wave signal, a triangular wave signal, a multiple level signal (e.g., has varying magnitude over time with respect to the DC component), and/or a polygonal signal (e.g., has a symmetrical or asymmetrical polygonal shape with respect to the DC component).

(64) In another example, the frequency of the oscillating component **94** may vary so that it can be tuned to the impedance of the sensor and/or to be off-set in frequency from other sensor signals in a system. For example, a capacitance sensor's impedance decreases with frequency. As such, if the frequency of the oscillating component is too high with respect to the capacitance, the capacitor looks like a short and variances in capacitances will be missed. Similarly, if the frequency of the oscillating component is too low with respect to the capacitance, the capacitor looks like an open and variances in capacitances will be missed.

(65) FIG. 7 is a frequency domain example graph that plots magnitude verses frequency for an analog reference signal **78**. As shown, the analog reference signal **78** includes the DC component **92** at DC (e.g., 0 Hz or near 0 Hz), a first oscillating component **94-1** at a first frequency ($f_{sub.1}$), and a second oscillating component **94-2** at a second frequency ($f_{sub.2}$). In an example, the DC component is used to measure resistance of an electrode (if desired), the first oscillating component **94-1** is used to measure the impedance of self capacitance, and the second oscillating component **94-2** is used to measure the impedance of mutual capacitance. Note that the second frequency may be greater than the first frequency.

(66) FIG. 8 is a schematic block diagram of an example of a first drive-sense circuit **60-1** coupled

to a first electrode **54-c** and a second drive-sense circuit **60-2** coupled to a second electrode **54-r** without a touch proximal to the electrodes. Each of the drive-sense circuits include a comparator, an analog to digital converter (ADC) **68**, a digital to analog converter (DAC) **70**, a signal source circuit **72**, and a driver. The functionality of this embodiment of a drive-sense circuit was described with reference to FIG. **3**. For additional embodiments of a drive-sense circuit see patent application entitled, "Drive-sense circuit with Drive-Sense Line" having issue date of Aug. 24, 2021, and a patent number of U.S. Pat. No. 11,099,032.

(67) As an example, a first reference signal **78-1** (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the first drive-sense circuit **60-1** and a second reference signal **78-2** (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the second drive-sense circuit **60-2**. The first reference signal includes a DC component and/or an oscillating at frequency $f_{sub.1}$. The second reference signal includes a DC component and/or two oscillating components: the first at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ and the second at frequency $f_{sub.2}$.

(68) The first drive-sense circuit **60-1** generates an electrode signal **76** based on the reference signal **78-1** and provides the electrode signal to the column electrode **54-c**. The second drive-sense circuit generates another electrode signal **76** based on the reference signal **78-2** and provides the electrode signal to the row electrode **54-r**.

(69) In response to the electrode signals being applied to the electrodes, the first drive-sense circuit **60-1** generates a first sensed signal **84-1**, which includes a component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ and a component a frequency $f_{sub.2}$. The component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ corresponds to the self capacitance of the column electrode **54-c** and the component a frequency $f_{sub.2}$ corresponds to the mutual capacitance between the row and column electrodes **54-c** and **54-r**. The self capacitance is expressed as $1/(2\pi f_{sub.1} C_{sub.p1})$ and the mutual capacitance is expressed as $1/(2\pi f_{sub.2} C_{sub.m_0})$.

(70) Also, in response to the electrode signals being applied to the electrodes, the second drive-sense circuit **60-2** generates a second sensed signal **84-2**, which includes a component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ and a component a frequency $f_{sub.2}$. The component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ corresponds to a shielded self capacitance of the row electrode **54-r** and the component a frequency $f_{sub.2}$ corresponds to an unshielded self capacitance of the row electrode **54-r**. The shielded self capacitance of the row electrode is expressed as $1/(2\pi f_{sub.1} C_{sub.p2})$ and the unshielded self capacitance of the row electrode is expressed as $1/(2\pi f_{sub.2} C_{sub.p2})$.

(71) With each active drive-sense circuit using the same frequency for self capacitance (e.g., $f_{sub.1}$), the row and column electrodes are at the same potential, which substantially eliminates cross-coupling between the electrodes. This provides a shielded (i.e., low noise) self capacitance measurement for the active drive-sense circuits. In this example, with the second drive-sense circuit transmitting the second frequency component, it has a second frequency component in its sensed signal but is primarily based on the row electrode's self capacitance with some cross coupling from other electrodes carrying signals at different frequencies. The cross coupling of signals at other frequencies injects unwanted noise into this self capacitance measurement and hence it is referred to as unshielded.

(72) FIG. **9** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) **96** that includes drive-sense circuits **60-1** and **60-2**, a 180° phase shifter **98**, and an output operational amplifier (op-amp) **100**. The drive-sense circuits **60-1** and **60-2** each include an op-amp **102-1** and **102-2**, and a regulated current source circuit **104-1** and **104-2**. Within the drive-sense circuit **60-1**, the positive input terminal of the op-amp **102-1** is coupled to a first electrode **54-1** of a differential electrode pair and the negative input terminal of the op-amp **102-1** is coupled to a voltage reference source (e.g., via a signal generator, via the processing module that generates and provides the voltage reference signal, etc.) that provides an analog reference signal (e.g., voltage reference signal VREF). Within the drive-sense circuit **60-2**, the positive input terminal of the op-amp **102-2** is coupled to the 180° phase shifter **98** which provides a 180° phase shifted version of the analog reference signal (voltage reference signal VREF') and the negative input terminal of the

op-amp **56-2** is coupled to a second electrode **54-2** of the differential electrode pair.

(73) The drive-sense circuits **60-1** and **60-2** operate similarly to the drive-sense circuit **60** of FIG. 3 where the feedback loops function to keep the electrode signals **76-1** and **76-2** substantially matching the analog reference signals (e.g., VREF and VREF'). As such, the electrode signal **76-1** will have a similar waveform to that of the VREF and the electrode signal **76-2** will have a similar waveform to that of the VREF'.

(74) The electrode signals **76-1** and **76-2** form a differential electrode signal that each include a drive signal component and a receive signal component. The op-amp **102-1** of the drive-sense circuit **60-1** compares the electrode signal **76-1** to the VREF signal to produce an analog comparison signal **106-1**. The analog comparison signal **106-1** contains a representation of the receive signal (e.g., the reference signal VREF and the receive signal). The analog comparison signal **106-1** is fed back to the regulated current source circuit **104-1** as analog feedback signal **108-1**. The regulated current source circuit **104-1** generates a regulated source signal **110-1** (e.g., a regulated current signal (I1)) based on the analog feedback signal **108-1**. The regulated current signal (I1) in combination with the impedance (Z) of the electrode creates a voltage (V), where $V=I*Z$. As the impedance (Z) of electrode changes, the regulated current (I) signal is adjusted to keep the voltage (V) substantially unchanged. For example, if the impedance increases the voltage on the electrode, the regulated current signal (I1) provides more current to keep the voltage substantially equal to VREF.

(75) The op-amp **102-2** of the drive-sense circuit **60-2** compares the electrode signal **76-2** to the VREF' signal (the 180° phase shifted VREF signal) to produce an analog comparison signal **106-2**. The analog comparison signal **106-2** contains a representation of the receive signal (e.g., the reference signal VREF' and the receive signal). The analog comparison signal **106-2** is fed back to the regulated current source circuit **104-2** as analog feedback signal **108-2**. The regulated current source circuit **104-2** generates a regulated source signal **110-2** (e.g., a regulated current signal (I2)) based on the analog feedback signal **108-2**. The regulated current signal (I2) in combination with the impedance (Z) of the electrode creates a voltage (V), where $V=I*Z$. As the impedance (Z) of the electrode changes, the regulated current (I) signal is adjusted to keep the voltage (V) substantially unchanged. For example, if the impedance lowers the voltage on the electrode, the regulated current signal (I2) is increased to keep the voltage substantially equal to VREF'.

(76) The output op-amp **100** compares the analog comparison signal **106-1** and the analog comparison signal **106-2** to produce an analog receive (RX) signal **112**. Comparing the analog comparison signal **106-1** and the analog comparison signal **106-2** cancels out the VREF and VREF' drive components due to the opposite phases and doubles the receive component. As such, the differential drive-sense circuit **96** is more sensitive than the drive-sense circuit **60** at sensing very small impedance changes because the sensed receive signal is doubled in comparison to the drive-sense circuit **60**. Further, with the differential drive-sense circuit **96**, because the VREF and VREF' components are canceled out in the analog RX signal, common mode noise is eliminated from the analog RX signal. Therefore, the differential drive-sense circuit **96** is more sensitive and has better signal to noise ratio than the drive-sense circuit **60**. Additionally, a lower magnitude VREF in comparison to the DSC embodiment may be used to reduce overall power.

(77) FIG. 10 is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a differential drive-sense circuit **96** (DDSC). The DDSC **96** of FIG. 10 operates similarly to the DDSC **96** of FIG. 9 except that the DDSC **96** of FIG. 10 includes an analog to digital converter (ADC) **114** coupled to the output op-amp **100** operable to convert the analog RX signal **112** to a digital sensed signal **116**. The analog to digital converter (ADC) **114** may be implemented in a variety of ways. For example, the ADC **114** is one of: a flash ADC, a successive approximation ADC, a ramp-compare ADC, a Wilkinson ADC, an integrating ADC, a delta encoded ADC, and/or a sigma-delta ADC.

(78) FIGS. 11A-11B are schematic block diagrams of examples of mutual capacitance electric fields of differential electrode pairs. A mutual capacitance is generated between electrodes due to

capacitive coupling. FIG. 11A depicts mutual capacitance electrical fields that exist between each differential electrode pair (e.g., “pair” mutual capacitance). A first electrode of a differential electrode pair is provided an analog reference signal (VREF) and a second electrode of the differential electrode pair is provided a phase-shifted analog reference signal (VREF'). The differential electrode pairs are positioned such that electrodes having in-phase reference signals are next to each other to eliminate cross-coupling between the row and column differential electrode pairs. As depicted in FIG. 11A, the pair mutual capacitance electrical fields are substantially kept between each differential electrode pair.

(79) FIG. 11B depicts mutual capacitance electrical fields that exist between a column differential electrode pair 54-c and a row differential electrode pair 54-r (e.g., “cross” mutual capacitance) as well as the pair mutual capacitance electrical fields of the column differential electrode pair 54-c and the row differential electrode pair 54-r. Because electrodes of a differential electrode pairs can be spaced closely together, the pair mutual capacitance is likely greater than a cross mutual capacitance.

(80) FIG. 12 is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a differential touch screen display that includes differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) 96-1 through 96-4, a first column differential electrode pair 54-c1, a second column differential electrode pair 54-c2, a first row differential electrode pair 54-r1, and a second row differential electrode pair 54-r2. The DDSCs 96-1 through 96-4 each operate similarly to the DDSC of FIG. 10 (e.g., including the ADC at the output) to provide differential electrode signals based on reference signals 1-4 (e.g., VREF) to the differential electrode pairs and generate sensed signals 1-4 representative of impedance changes of the differential electrode pairs.

(81) As an example, a reference signal 1 (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the DDSC 96-1, a reference signal 2 (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the DDSC 96-2, a reference signal 3 (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the DDSC 96-3, and a reference signal 4 (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the DDSC 96-4. The reference signal 1 includes a DC component and/or an oscillating at frequency f.sub.1, the reference signal 2 includes a DC component and/or an oscillating at frequency f.sub.1, the reference signal 3 includes a DC component and/or two oscillating components: the first at frequency f.sub.1 and the second at frequency f.sub.2, and the reference signal 4 includes a DC component and/or two oscillating components: the first at frequency f.sub.1 and a third frequency at frequency f.sub.3.

(82) The DDSC 96-1 generates a differential electrode signal based on the reference signal 1 and provides the differential electrode signal to a first column differential electrode pair 54-c1. The DDSC 96-2 generates a differential electrode signal based on the reference signal 2 and provides the differential electrode signal to a second column differential electrode pair 54-c2. The DDSC 96-3 generates a differential electrode signal based on the reference signal 3 and provides the differential electrode signal to a first row differential electrode pair 54-r1. The DDSC 96-4 generates an electrode signal based on the reference signal 4 and provides the electrode signal to a second column differential electrode pair 54-r2.

(83) In response to the differential electrode signals being applied to the differential electrode pairs, the DDSC 96-1 generates a sensed signal 1, which includes a component at frequency f.sub.1, a component a frequency f.sub.2, and a component a frequency f.sub.3. The component at frequency f.sub.1 corresponds to the self capacitance of the first column differential electrode pair 54-c1 (e.g., a combination of capacitances C.sub.p11 and C.sub.p12), the component at frequency f.sub.2 corresponds to the mutual capacitance between the first row differential electrode pair 54-r1 and first column differential electrode pair 54-c1 (e.g., a parallel combination of 4 capacitances C.sub.p1-3), and the component at frequency f.sub.3 corresponds to the mutual capacitance between the second row differential electrode pair 54-r2 and first column differential electrode pair 54-c1 (e.g., a parallel combination of 4 capacitances C.sub.p1-4).

(84) In response to the electrode signals being applied to the differential electrode pairs, the DDSC

96-2 generates a sensed signal **2**, which includes a component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$, a component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$, and a component at frequency $f_{sub.3}$. The component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ corresponds to the self capacitance of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** (e.g., a combination of capacitances $C_{sub.p21}$ and $C_{sub.p22}$), the component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$ corresponds to the mutual capacitance between the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** (e.g., a parallel combination of 4 capacitances $C_{sub.p2-3}$), and the component at frequency $f_{sub.3}$ corresponds to the mutual capacitance between the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** and second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** (e.g., a parallel combination of 4 capacitances $C_{sub.p2-4}$).

(85) In response to the electrode signals being applied to the differential electrode pairs, the DDSC **96-3** generates the sensed signal **3**, which includes a component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$, a component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$, and a component at frequency $f_{sub.3}$. The component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ corresponds to a shielded self capacitance of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** (e.g., a combination of capacitances $C_{sub.p31}$ and $C_{sub.p32}$), the component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$ corresponds to an unshielded self capacitance of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**, and the component at frequency $f_{sub.3}$ corresponds to an unshielded self capacitance of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. Because cross mutual capacitance of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and the first and second column differential electrode pairs is detected in sensed signals **1** and **2**, only the self capacitance of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** is needed.

(86) In response to the electrode signals being applied to the differential electrode pairs, the DDSC **96-4** generates the sensed signal **4**, which includes a component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$, a component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$, and a component at frequency $f_{sub.3}$. The component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ corresponds to a shielded self capacitance of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** (e.g., a combination of capacitances $C_{sub.p41}$ and $C_{sub.p42}$), the component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$ corresponds to an unshielded self capacitance of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**, and the component at frequency $f_{sub.3}$ corresponds to an unshielded self capacitance of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**. Because cross mutual capacitance of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** and the first and second column differential electrode pairs is detected in sensed signals **1** and **2**, only the self capacitance of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** is needed.

(87) With the DDSCs **96-3** and **96-4** transmitting the second and third frequency components, they have a second and third frequency component in their sensed signals but they are primarily based on the each differential row electrode pair's self capacitance with some cross coupling from other electrodes carrying signals at different frequencies.

(88) Each active differential drive-sense circuit uses the same frequency for self capacitance (e.g., $f_{sub.1}$), such that the differential electrode pairs are at the same potential, which substantially eliminates cross-coupling between the differential electrode pairs. Further, the differential signaling and the positioning of electrodes having in-phase reference signals next to each other eliminates cross-coupling between the differential electrode pairs. Because self capacitance is greater than mutual capacitance, cross coupling of mutual capacitance with self capacitance is insignificant.

(89) The pair mutual capacitances shown (e.g., $C_{sub.m_c1}$, $C_{sub.m_c2}$, $C_{sub.m_r1}$, and $C_{sub.m_r2}$) are not detected in this example because self capacitance of a differential electrode pair is much greater than pair mutual capacitance. The cross mutual capacitances and self capacitances provide enough data to detect touches and hovers. Detection of pair mutual capacitances in order to improve and/or enable touch and/or hover detection will be discussed with reference to one or more of the following Figures.

(90) FIGS. **13A-13B** are schematic block diagrams of embodiments of a plurality of electrodes creating a plurality of touch sense cells **118** within a touch screen display. In FIG. **13A**, a plurality of second electrodes **120** are perpendicular and on a different layer of the display than a plurality of

first electrodes **122**. For each crossing of a first electrode and a second electrode, a touch sense cell **118** is created. At each touch sense cell **118**, a mutual capacitance ($C_{sub.m_0}$) is created between the crossing electrodes. Each second electrode also includes a self capacitance ($C_{sub.p2}$) and each first electrode also includes a self capacitance ($C_{sub.p1}$) which are shown as single parasitic capacitances, but, in some instances, are distributed R-C circuits.

(91) A drive-sense circuit (DSC) is coupled to a corresponding one of the electrodes. The drive-sense circuits (DSC) provides electrode signals to the electrodes and determines the loading on the electrode signals of the electrodes. When no touch is present, each touch cell **138** will have a similar mutual capacitance and each electrode of a similar length will have a similar self capacitance. When a touch is applied on or near a touch sense cell **118**, the mutual capacitance of the cell will decrease (creating an increased impedance) and the self capacitances of the electrodes creating the touch sense cell will increase (creating a decreased impedance). Between these impedance changes, the processing module can detect the location of a touch, or touches.

(92) In FIG. **13B**, a plurality of second differential electrode pairs is perpendicular and on a different layer of the display than a plurality of first differential electrode pairs. For each crossing of a first differential electrode pair and a second differential electrode pair, a touch sense cell **118** is created. At each touch sense cell **118**, a mutual capacitance ($C_{sub.m}$) is created between the crossing electrodes. In comparison to FIG. **13A**, the mutual capacitance $C_{sub.m}$ is greater than the mutual capacitance $C_{sub.m_0}$ due to the additional row and column crossings. Therefore, in FIG. **13B**, mutual capacitance change detection is more sensitive than in FIG. **13A**.

(93) Each second differential electrode pair also includes a self capacitance ($C_{sub.p22}$) and each first differential electrode pair also includes a self capacitance ($C_{sub.p11}$) which are shown as single parasitic capacitances, but, in some instances, are distributed R-C circuits. In comparison to FIG. **13A**, the self capacitance $C_{sub.p22}$ is greater than the self capacitance $C_{sub.p2}$ and the self capacitance $C_{sub.p11}$ is greater than the self capacitance $C_{sub.p1}$ due to the additional electrodes. Therefore, in FIG. **13B**, self capacitance change detection is more sensitive than in FIG. **13A**.

(94) A differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) is coupled to a corresponding one of the differential electrode pairs. The differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) provides electrode signals to the differential electrode pairs and determines the loading on the electrode signals of the differential electrode pairs. When no touch is present, each touch cell **118** will have a similar mutual capacitance and each differential electrode pair of a similar length will have a similar self capacitance. When a touch is applied on or near a touch sense cell **118**, the mutual capacitance of the cell will decrease (creating an increased impedance) and the self capacitances of the differential electrode pairs creating the touch sense cell will increase (creating a decreased impedance). Between these impedance changes, the processing module can detect the location of a touch, or touches.

(95) FIGS. **14A-14D** are schematic block diagrams of embodiments of touch screen electrode patterns that include row differential electrode pairs **54-r** and column differential electrode pairs **54-c**. Each row differential electrode pair **54-r** and each column differential electrode pair **54-r** includes a plurality of individual conductive cells (e.g., capacitive sense plates) (e.g., white cells for columns, gray cells for rows) that are electrically coupled together. The size of a cell depends on the desired resolution of touch sensing. For example, a cell size may be 1 millimeter by 1 millimeter to 5 millimeters by 5 millimeters to provide adequate touch sensing for cell phones and tablets. Making the cells smaller improves touch resolution and will typically reduce touch sensor errors (e.g., touching a “w” by an “e” is displayed).

(96) Mutual capacitance is generated between a differential pair of electrodes and at a crossing of a row and column differential pair of electrodes. Therefore, a differential electrode pair configuration has increased mutual capacitance in comparison to a single electrode configuration (e.g., where mutual capacitance is generated between a row and column electrode). Various cell shapes, patterns, and dielectric materials can be used to further increase mutual capacitance of differential

electrode pair configurations. Based on the capacitance equation $C = \epsilon A/d$, where ϵ is a dielectric constant, A is the area of a plate, and d is the distance between the plates, the cells for a differential pair of electrodes should be as close as possible (e.g., decrease d) and have as large of an area as possible and practical (e.g., increase A) to increase mutual capacitance. Further, the cross sections of row differential pairs of electrodes and column differential pairs of electrodes should be as close as possible (e.g., decrease d) and have as large of an area as possible and practical (e.g., increase A) to increase mutual capacitance. A dielectric material with a higher dielectric constant could also be used between the differential pairs and the cross sections of rows and columns to increase mutual capacitance.

(97) The cells for the row and column differential electrode pairs may be on the same layer or on different layers. In FIG. 14A, the cells for the row and column differential electrode pairs are shown on different layers where each row and column differential electrode pair is coupled to a differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC). While the cells are shown to be square, they may be of any polygonal shape, diamond, or circular shape. With the cells for the row and column differential electrode pairs on different layers, a square or rectangular shape allows the differential electrode pairs to be close together and have as large of an area as required for enhanced mutual capacitance. Further, a dielectric material could be used between the layers to increase mutual capacitance between the row and column differential electrode pairs.

(98) In FIGS. 14B-14D, the cells for row and column differential electrode pairs are shown on the same layer. The electric coupling between the cells is done using vias and running traces (e.g., wire traces) on another layer. Note that the cells may be on one or more ITO layers of a touch screen, which includes a touch screen display. With the cells for the row and column differential electrode pairs on the same layer, the position, pattern, size, and shape of differential electrode pairs should be considered in order to increase mutual capacitance and not to interfere with the benefits that differential electrode pairs provide (e.g., decreased noise and increased sensing sensitivity). For example, one electrode of a differential electrode pair should not be placed too far from the other electrode of the differential electrode pair or be separated by an electrode of a different differential electrode pair.

(99) FIGS. 14B-14D depict various cell shapes and electrode patterns that could be used for the row and column differential electrode pairs on a single layer. For example, in FIG. 14B one electrode of a differential electrode pair includes electrically coupled half squares (e.g., right triangles) and the other electrode of the differential electrode pair includes electrically coupled half squares such that the two sets of half squares form a separated square. Mutual capacitance is generated between the half squares of a differential electrode pair and wherever a row differential electrode pair and a column differential electrode pair intersect.

(100) FIG. 14C is similar to FIG. 14B except that the half squares have clipped corners to increase the area at a row and column cross sections which may increase mutual capacitance. In FIG. 14D, the cells have an elongated octagonal shape to increase the area at a row and column cross section. Other cell shapes and electrode patterns are possible. Further, a dielectric material could be used between the differential electrode pairs to increase mutual capacitance.

(101) FIG. 15 is a schematic block diagram of an example of a first differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) 96-1 coupled to a column differential electrode pair 54-c and a third differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) 96-3 coupled to a row differential electrode pair 54-r without a touch proximal to the electrodes. Each of the differential drive-sense circuits operate similarly to the DDSC of FIGS. 9 and 10.

(102) As an example, a first reference signal 124-1 (e.g., VREF) is provided to the first differential drive-sense circuit 96-1 and a third reference signal 124-3 is provided to the third differential drive-sense circuit 96-3. The first reference signal includes a DC component and/or an oscillating at frequency $f_{\text{sub.1}}$. The third reference signal includes a DC component and/or two oscillating components: the first at frequency $f_{\text{sub.1}}$ and the second at frequency $f_{\text{sub.2}}$.

(103) The first differential drive-sense circuit **96-1** generates a differential electrode signal (e.g., first and second electrode signals **76-1** and **76-2**) based on the reference signal **124-1** and provides the electrode signal **76-1** to the first column electrode **54-c1** of the column differential electrode pair **54-c** and provides the electrode signal **76-2** to the second column electrode **54-c2** of the column differential electrode pair **54-c**. The third differential drive-sense circuit **96-3** generates a differential electrode signal (e.g., first and second electrode signals **76-1** and **76-2**) based on the reference signal **124-3** and provides the electrode signal **76-1** to the first row electrode **54-r1** of the row differential electrode pair **54-r** and provides the electrode signal **76-2** to the second row electrode **54-r2** of the row differential electrode pair **54-r**.

(104) In response to the differential electrode signals being applied to the electrodes, the first differential drive-sense circuit **96-1** generates a first sensed signal **116-1**, which includes a component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ and a component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$. The component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ corresponds to the self capacitance of the column differential electrode pair **54-c** and the component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$ corresponds to the mutual capacitance between the row and column differential electrode pairs **54-c** and **54-r**. The self capacitance is expressed as $1/(2\pi f_{sub.1} C_{sub.p1})$ and the mutual capacitance is expressed as $1/(2\pi f_{sub.2} C_{sub.m})$ where $C_{sub.p1}$ is a combination of $C_{sub.p11}$ and $C_{sub.p12}$ and $C_{sub.m}$ is a combination of four cross mutual capacitances at $C_{sub.m1-3}$.

(105) Also, in response to the electrode signals being applied to the electrodes, the third differential drive-sense circuit **96-3** generates a third sensed signal **116-3**, which includes a component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ and a component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$. The component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ corresponds to a shielded self capacitance of the row differential electrode pair **54-r** and the component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$ corresponds to an unshielded self capacitance of the row differential electrode pair **54-r**. The shielded self capacitance of the row differential electrode pair is expressed as $1/(2\pi f_{sub.1} C_{sub.p2})$ and the unshielded self capacitance of the row differential electrode pair is expressed as $1/(2\pi f_{sub.2} C_{sub.p2})$ where $C_{sub.p2}$ is a combination of capacitances $C_{sub.p21}$ and $C_{sub.p22}$.

(106) With each active differential drive-sense circuit using the same frequency for self capacitance (e.g., $f_{sub.1}$), the row and column differential electrode pairs are at the same potential, which substantially eliminates cross-coupling between the row and column differential electrode pairs. This provides a shielded (i.e., low noise) self capacitance measurement for the active differential drive-sense circuits. In this example, with the third differential drive-sense circuit transmitting the second frequency component, it has a second frequency component in its sensed signal but is primarily based on the row differential electrode pair's self capacitance with some cross coupling from other electrodes carrying signals at different frequencies. The cross coupling of signals at other frequencies injects unwanted noise into this self capacitance measurement and hence it is referred to as unshielded.

(107) FIG. 15A is a schematic block diagram of an example of a first differential drive sense circuit **96-1** coupled to a column differential electrode pair **54-c** and a third differential drive sense circuit **96-3** coupled to a row differential electrode pair **54-r** with a grounded touch proximal to the electrodes. The example of FIG. 15A is similar to the example of FIG. 15 with the difference being the grounded touch proximal to the differential electrode pairs (e.g., a touch that shadows the intersection of the differential electrode pairs or is physically close to the intersection of the differential electrode pairs). With the grounded touch (e.g., a finger touch, etc.), the self-capacitance and the mutual capacitance of the electrodes are changed.

(108) In this example, the impedance of the self-capacitance at $f_{sub.1}$ of the column differential electrode pair **54-c** now includes the effect of the finger capacitance. As such, the impedance of the self-capacitance of the column differential electrode pair **54-c** equals $1/(2\pi f_{sub.1} * (C_{sub.p1} + C_{sub.f1}))$, which is included in the sensed signal **116-1**. The second frequency component at $f_{sub.2}$ corresponds to the impedance of the mutual capacitance at $f_{sub.2}$, which includes the

effect of the finger capacitance. As such, the impedance of the mutual capacitance equals

$1/(2\pi f_{\text{sub.2}} C_{\text{sub.m}_1})$, where $C_{\text{sub.m}_1} = (C_{\text{m}} * C_{\text{sub.f1}}) / (C_{\text{sub.m}} + C_{\text{sub.f1}})$.

(109) Continuing with this example, the first frequency component at $f_{\text{sub.1}}$ of the third sensed signal **116-3** corresponds to the impedance of the shielded self-capacitance of the row differential electrode pair **54-r** at $f_{\text{sub.1}}$, which is affected by the finger capacitance. As such, the impedance of the capacitance of the row differential electrode pair **54-r** equals $1/(2\pi f_{\text{sub.1}} * (C_{\text{sub.p2}} + C_{\text{sub.f2}}))$.

The second frequency component at $f_{\text{sub.2}}$ of the third sensed signal **116-3** corresponds to the impedance of the unshielded self-capacitance at $f_{\text{sub.2}}$, which includes the effect of the finger capacitance and is equal to $1/(2\pi f_{\text{sub.2}} * (C_{\text{sub.p2}} + C_{\text{sub.f2}}))$.

(110) FIG. **15B** is a schematic block diagram of an example of a first differential drive sense circuit **96-1** coupled to a column differential electrode pair **54-c** and a third differential drive sense circuit **96-3** coupled to a row differential electrode pair **54-r** with an ungrounded touch proximal to the electrodes. The example of FIG. **15B** is similar to the example of FIG. **15** with the difference being the ungrounded touch proximal to the differential electrode pairs (e.g., a touch that shadows the intersection of the differential electrode pairs or is physically close to the intersection of the differential electrode pairs). With the ungrounded touch (e.g., an ungrounded object), only mutual capacitance of the electrode pairs is changed. With greater mutual capacitance change sensitivity, the differential drive-sense circuits are better at detecting ungrounded objects than drive-sense circuits.

(111) In this example, the impedance of the self-capacitance at $f_{\text{sub.1}}$ of the column differential electrode pair **54-c** remains substantially unchanged due to the ungrounded object. As such, the impedance of the self-capacitance of the column differential electrode pair **54-c** equals $1/(2\pi f_{\text{sub.1}} * (C_{\text{sub.p1}}))$, which is included the sensed signal **116-1**. The second frequency component at $f_{\text{sub.2}}$ corresponds to the impedance of the mutual capacitance at $f_{\text{sub.2}}$, which includes the effect of the ungrounded object capacitance. As such, the impedance of the mutual capacitance equals $1/(2\pi f_{\text{sub.2}} C_{\text{sub.m}_2})$, where $C_{\text{sub.m}_2} = (C_{\text{sub.m}} * C_{\text{sub.O1}}) / (C_{\text{sub.m}} + C_{\text{sub.O1}})$.

(112) Continuing with this example, the first frequency component at $f_{\text{sub.1}}$ of the third sensed signal **116-3** corresponds to the impedance of the shielded self-capacitance of the row differential electrode pair **54-r** at f_1 , which remains substantially unchanged by the ungrounded object capacitance. As such, the impedance of the capacitance of the row differential electrode pair **54-r** equals $1/(2\pi f_{\text{sub.1}} * C_{\text{sub.p2}})$. The second frequency component at $f_{\text{sub.2}}$ of the third sensed signal **116-3** corresponds to the impedance of the unshielded self-capacitance at $f_{\text{sub.2}}$, which remains substantially unchanged by the ungrounded object capacitance and is equal to $1/(2\pi f_{\text{sub.2}} * (C_{\text{sub.p2}}))$. In another embodiment, any small changes detected in the self capacitance measurements could be attributable to pair mutual capacitances when detecting an ungrounded object.

(113) FIG. **16** is a schematic block diagram of a touchless example of a few differential drive-sense circuits **96-1** and **96-3** and a portion of the touch screen processing module **56** of a differential touch screen display **44**. The portion of the processing module **56** includes analog to digital converters (ADCs) **114-1** and **114-3** (e.g., when the DDSCs do not include ADCs), band pass filters **136**, **138**, **136-1**, & **138-3**, and frequency interpreters **164** & **164-3**, and **166** & **166-3**. As previously discussed, a first differential drive-sense circuit is coupled to a first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and a third differential drive-sense circuit is coupled to a first row differential electrode pair electrode **54-r1**.

(114) The differential drive-sense circuits **96** provide electrode signals to their respective differential electrode pairs **54** and produce therefrom respective sensed signals **116**. The first sensed signal **116-1** includes a first frequency component at $f_{\text{sub.1}}$ that corresponds to the self capacitance of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and a second frequency component at $f_{\text{sub.2}}$ that corresponds to the mutual capacitance between the first column differential electrode pair **54-**

c1 and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. The second sensed signal **116-3** includes a first frequency component at **f.sub.1** that corresponds to the shielded self capacitance of the first row differential electrode pair electrode **54-r1** and/or a second frequency component at **f.sub.2** that corresponds to the unshielded self capacitance of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. In an embodiment, the sensed signals **116** are frequency domain digital signals.

(115) The first bandpass filter **136** passes (i.e., substantially unattenuated) signals in a bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency **f.sub.1** and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. As such, the first bandpass filter **136** passes the portion of the sensed signal **116-1** that corresponds to the self capacitance of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1**. In an embodiment, the sensed signal **116** is a digital signal, thus, the first bandpass filter **136** is a digital filter such as a cascaded integrated comb (CIC) filter, a finite impulse response (FIR) filter, an infinite impulse response (IIR) filter, a Butterworth filter, a Chebyshev filter, an elliptic filter, etc.

(116) The frequency interpreter **164** receives the first bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a self capacitance (“cap”) **128-1** value for the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1**. As an example, the frequency interpreter **164** is a processing module, or portion thereof, that executes a function to convert the first bandpass filter sensed signal into the self capacitance **128-1** value, which is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value). As another example, the frequency interpreter **164** is a look up table where the first bandpass filter sensed signal is an index for the table.

(117) The second bandpass filter **138** passes, substantially unattenuated, signals in a second bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency **f.sub.2** and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. As such, the second bandpass filter **138** passes the portion of the sensed signal **116-1** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance between the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. In an embodiment, the sensed signal **116-1** is a digital signal, thus, the second bandpass filter **138** is a digital filter such as a cascaded integrated comb (CIC) filter, a finite impulse response (FIR) filter, an infinite impulse response (IIR) filter, a Butterworth filter, a Chebyshev filter, an elliptic filter, etc.

(118) The frequency interpreter **166** receives the second bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **130-1** value. As an example, the frequency interpreter **166** is a processing module, or portion thereof, that executes a function to convert the second bandpass filter sensed signal into the mutual capacitance **130-1** value, which is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), and/or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value). As another example, the frequency interpreter **166** is a look up table where the first bandpass filter sensed signal is an index for the table.

(119) For the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**, the differential drive-sense circuit **96-3** produces a third sensed signal **116-3**, which includes a shielded self capacitance component and/or an unshielded self capacitance component. The third bandpass filter **136-3** is similar to the first bandpass filter **136** and, as such passes signals in a bandpass region centered about frequency **f.sub.1** and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. In this example, the third bandpass filter **136-3** passes the portion of the third sensed signal **116-3** that corresponds to the shielded self capacitance of the row differential electrode pair **54-r**.

(120) The frequency interpreter **164-3** receives the third bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a shielded self capacitance (“cap”) **132-3** value for the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. The frequency interpreter **164-3** may be implemented similarly to the first frequency interpreter **164** or an integrated portion thereof. In an embodiment, the shielded self capacitance **132-3** value is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100),

or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value).

(121) The fourth bandpass filter **138-3**, if included, is similar to the second bandpass filter **138**. As such, it passes, substantially unattenuated, signals in a bandpass region centered about frequency $f_{sub.2}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. In this example, the fourth bandpass filter **138-3** passes the portion of the third sensed signal **116-3** that corresponds to the unshielded self capacitance of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**.

(122) The frequency interpreter **166-3**, if included, receives the fourth bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render an unshielded self capacitance (“cap”) **134-3** value. The frequency interpreter **166-3** may be implemented similarly to the frequency interpreter **166** or an integrated portion thereof. In an embodiment, the unshielded self capacitance **134-3** value is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value). Note that the unshielded self capacitance may be ignored, thus band pass filter **138-3** and frequency interpreter **166-3** may be omitted.

(123) FIG. **17** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55** that includes differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) **96-1** through **96-4**, a first and second column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and **54-c2**, and a first and second row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and **54-r2**. The no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55** of FIG. **17** operates similarly to the touch screen display of FIG. **12** except that there is no ground plane. Without a ground connection at each electrode, self capacitance cannot be measured. However, due to increased mutual capacitance generated by the differential electrode pairs as previously discussed, mutual capacitance detection is improved and can be used to detect touches, hovers, and un-grounded objects without the need of self capacitance detection.

(124) The DDSCs **96-1** through **96-4** operate similarly to the DDSCs of FIG. **10** (e.g., including the ADC at the output) to provide reference signals **1-4** (e.g., VREF) to the differential electrode pairs and generate sensed signals **1-4** representative of impedance changes of the differential electrode pairs.

(125) As an example, a reference signal **1** (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the DDSC **96-1**, a reference signal **2** (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the DDSC **96-2**, a reference signal **3** (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the DDSC **96-3**, and a reference signal **4** (e.g., analog or digital) is provided to the DDSC **96-4**. The reference signal **1** includes a DC component and/or an oscillating at frequency $f_{sub.1}$, the reference signal **2** includes a DC component and/or an oscillating at frequency $f_{sub.2}$, the reference signal **3** includes a DC component and/or an oscillating at frequency $f_{sub.3}$, and the reference signal **4** includes a DC component and/or an oscillating at frequency $f_{sub.4}$.

(126) The DDSC **96-1** generates an electrode signal based on the reference signal **1** and provides the electrode signal to the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1**. The DDSC **96-2** generates an electrode signal based on the reference signal **2** and provides the electrode signal to the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2**. The DDSC **96-3** generates an electrode signal based on the reference signal **3** and provides the electrode signal to the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. The DDSC **96-4** generates an electrode signal based on the reference signal **4** and provides the electrode signal to the second column differential electrode pair **54-r2**.

(127) In response to the electrode signals being applied to the differential electrode pairs, the DDSC **96-1** generates a sensed signal **1**, which includes components at frequencies $f_{sub.1}$ - $f_{sub.4}$. The component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ corresponds to the mutual capacitance of first and second electrodes of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** or $C_{sub.m1}$.

(128) In response to the electrode signals being applied to the differential electrode pairs, the DDSC **96-2** generates a sensed signal **2**, which includes components at frequencies $f_{sub.1}$ - $f_{sub.4}$. The component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$ corresponds to the mutual capacitance of first and second

electrodes of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** or C.sub.m2.

(129) In response to the electrode signals being applied to the differential electrode pairs, the DDSC **96-3** generates a sensed signal **3**, which includes components at frequencies f.sub.1-f.sub.4. The component at frequency f.sub.3 corresponds to the mutual capacitance of first and second electrodes of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** or C.sub.m3.

(130) In response to the electrode signals being applied to the differential electrode pairs, the DDSC **96-4** generates a sensed signal **4**, which includes components at frequencies f.sub.1-f.sub.4. The component at frequency f.sub.4 corresponds to the mutual capacitance of first and second electrodes of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** or C.sub.m4.

(131) With no ground plane, the electrical field (generated by mutual capacitance) does not radiate outwards but stays between differential pairs. Each active differential drive-sense circuit uses a different frequency for measuring mutual capacitance of a differential electrode pair (e.g., f.sub.1-f.sub.4) to isolate the intended mutual capacitance measurement. Unlike self capacitance measurement, cross coupling between cross mutual capacitance and pair mutual capacitance is possible and thus different frequencies for measuring mutual capacitance are required. The differential electrode pairs are positioned such that electrodes having in-phase reference signals are next to each other to substantially eliminate cross-coupling between the row and column differential electrode pairs.

(132) FIG. **18** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55** that includes differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) **96-1** through **96-4**, a first and second column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and **54-c2**, and a first and second row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and **54-r2**. FIG. **18** operates similarly to the no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55** of FIG. **17** and shows an example of detecting a touch and/or hover **140** on the no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55**. The touch and/or hover **140** shown causes a decrease in the mutual capacitance between a first column differential electrode pair **54-c** (e.g., C.sub.m1) and a decrease in the mutual capacitance between a first row differential electrode pair **54-r** (e.g., C.sub.m3).

(133) The DDSCs **1** and **3** produce sensed signals representative of these changes and a processing module is operable to interpret the changes as mutual capacitance measurements and interpret the mutual capacitance measurements as user inputs. For example, a smaller mutual capacitance decrease may indicate a hover user input and a larger mutual capacitance decrease may indicate a touch user input. Further, the location and duration of the mutual capacitance changes may indicate particular user input functions (e.g., a selection, scroll, etc.).

(134) FIG. **19** is a schematic block diagram of an example of column differential drive-sense circuits **96-1** and **96-2** (e.g., DDSC **96-1** and **2** of FIGS. **17-18**) and a portion of the touch screen processing module of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display. The portion of the processing module includes analog to digital converters (ADCs) **114-1** and **114-2** (e.g., when the DDSCs do not include ADCs), band pass filters **136** and **138** and frequency interpreters **164** and **166**. A first differential drive-sense circuit **96-1** is coupled to a first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and a second differential drive-sense circuit **96-2** is coupled to a second column differential electrode pair electrode **54-c2**.

(135) The differential drive-sense circuits **96** provide electrode signals to their respective differential electrode pairs **54** and produce therefrom respective sensed signals **116**. The first sensed signal **116-1** includes a first frequency component at f.sub.1 that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the first and second electrodes of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1**. A second frequency component at f.sub.2 is not included in the sensed signal **116-1** since coupling between the column differential pairs does not occur.

(136) The second sensed signal **116-2** includes a second frequency component at f.sub.2 that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the first and second electrodes of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2**. A frequency component at f.sub.1 is not included in the sensed

signal **116-2** because coupling between the column differential pairs does not occur. In an embodiment, the sensed signals **116** are frequency domain digital signals.

(137) The first bandpass filter **136** passes (i.e., substantially unattenuated) signals in a bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency $f_{\text{sub.1}}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. As such, the first bandpass filter **136** passes the portion of the sensed signal **116-1** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1**. In an embodiment, the sensed signal **116-1** is a digital signal, thus, the first bandpass filter **136** is a digital filter such as a cascaded integrated comb (CIC) filter, a finite impulse response (FIR) filter, an infinite impulse response (IIR) filter, a Butterworth filter, a Chebyshev filter, an elliptic filter, etc.

(138) The frequency interpreter **164** receives the first bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **130** value for the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1**. As an example, the frequency interpreter **164** is a processing module, or portion thereof, that executes a function to convert the first bandpass filter sensed signal into the mutual capacitance **130** value, which is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value). As another example, the frequency interpreter **164** is a look up table where the first bandpass filter sensed signal is an index for the table.

(139) For the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2**, the differential drive-sense circuit **96-2** produces a second sensed signal **116-2**. The bandpass filter **138** passes, substantially unattenuated, signals in a bandpass region centered about frequency $f_{\text{sub.2}}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. In this example, the bandpass filter **138** passes the portion of the second sensed signal **116-2** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2**.

(140) The frequency interpreter **166** receives the second bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **133** value for the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2**. The frequency interpreter **166** may be implemented similarly to the first frequency interpreter **164** or an integrated portion thereof. In an embodiment, the mutual capacitance **133** value is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value).

(141) FIG. **20** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55** that includes differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) **96-1** through **96-4**, a first and second column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and **54-c2**, and a first and second row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and **54-r2**. FIG. **20** operates similarly to the no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55** of FIG. **17** and shows an example of detecting two touches and/or hovers **140-1** and **140-2** simultaneously on the no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55**. The touch and/or hover **140-1** shown causes a decrease in the mutual capacitance between the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** (e.g., $C_{\text{sub.m1}}$) and a decrease in the mutual capacitance between the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** (e.g., $C_{\text{sub.m3}}$).

(142) The touch and/or hover **140-2** shown causes a decrease in the mutual capacitance between the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** (e.g., $C_{\text{sub.m2}}$) and a decrease in the mutual capacitance between a second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** (e.g., $C_{\text{sub.m4}}$).

(143) Because the simultaneous touches **140-1** and **140-2** cause decreases in the mutual capacitances $C_{\text{sub.m1}}$, $C_{\text{sub.m2}}$, $C_{\text{sub.m3}}$, and $C_{\text{sub.m4}}$ simultaneously, a ghost (i.e., not real) touch/hover **142-1** is sensed at the intersection of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** and a ghost touch/hover **142-2** is sensed at the intersection of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. In this example, the no-ground plane differential touch screen display is unable to distinguish between the real touches **140-1** and **140-2** and ghost touches **142-1** and **142-2**.

(144) FIGS. 21A-21B are schematic block diagrams of embodiments of differential drive-sense circuits and a portion of the touch screen processing module of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display. FIG. 21A includes row differential drive-sense circuits **96-3** and **96-4** (e.g., DDSC **96-3** and **96-4** of FIG. 20) and a portion of the touch screen processing module of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display. The portion of the processing module includes analog to digital converters (ADCs) **114-3** and **114-4** (e.g., when the DDSCs do not include ADCs), band pass filters **144** and **150** and frequency interpreters **146** and **152**. A differential drive-sense circuit **96-3** is coupled to a first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and a differential drive-sense circuit **96-4** is coupled to a second row differential electrode pair electrode **54-r2**.

(145) The DDSC **96-3** generates an electrode signal based on the reference signal **3** (where reference signal **3** includes the frequency component at f.sub.3) and provides the electrode signal to the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. The DDSC **96-4** generates an electrode signal based on the reference signal **4** (where reference signal **4** includes the frequency component at f.sub.4) and provides the electrode signal to the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**.

(146) FIG. 21B includes column differential drive-sense circuits **96-1** and **96-2** (e.g., DDSC **96-1** and **96-2** of FIG. 20) and a portion of the touch screen processing module of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display. The portion of the processing module includes analog to digital converters (ADCs) **114-1** and **114-2** (e.g., when the DDSCs do not include ADCs), band pass filters **136**, **138**, **144-1** & **144-2**, and **150-1** & **150-2** and frequency interpreters **164**, **166**, **146-1** & **146-2**, and **152-1** and **152-2**. A differential drive-sense circuit **96-1** is coupled to a first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and a differential drive-sense circuit **96-2** is coupled to a second column differential electrode pair electrode **54-c2**.

(147) The DDSC **96-1** generates an electrode signal based on the reference signal **1** (where reference signal **1** includes the frequency component at f.sub.1) and provides the electrode signal to the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1**. The DDSC **96-2** generates an electrode signal based on the reference signal **2** (where reference signal **2** includes the frequency component at f.sub.2) and provides the electrode signal to the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2**.

(148) The differential drive-sense circuits provide electrode signals to their respective differential electrode pairs and produce therefrom respective sensed signals. Referring back to FIG. 21A, the sensed signal **116-3** includes frequency components f.sub.1-f.sub.3. The first frequency component at f.sub.1 corresponds to a mutual capacitance at a crossing of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and the first column differential electrode pair **54-c2** of FIG. 21B. The second frequency component at f.sub.2 corresponds to a mutual capacitance at a crossing of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** of FIG. 21. The third frequency component at f.sub.3 corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the first and second electrodes of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. A fourth frequency component at f.sub.4 is included in the sensed signal since coupling between the row differential pairs does not occur.

(149) The sensed signal **116-4** includes frequency components f.sub.1, f.sub.2, and f.sub.4. The first frequency component at f.sub.1 corresponds to a mutual capacitance at a crossing of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** and the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** of FIG. 21B. The second frequency component at f.sub.2 corresponds to a mutual capacitance at a crossing of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** and the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** of FIG. 21B. The fourth frequency component at f.sub.4 corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the first and second electrodes of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**. The third frequency component at f.sub.3 is not included in the sensed signal since coupling between the row differential pairs does not occur. In an embodiment, the sensed signals **116** are frequency domain digital signals.

(150) The bandpass filter **144** passes (i.e., substantially unattenuated) signals in a bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency f.sub.3 and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. As such, the bandpass filter **144** passes the

portion of the sensed signal **116-3** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. In an embodiment, the sensed signal **116-3** is a digital signal, thus, the first bandpass filter **144** is a digital filter such as a cascaded integrated comb (CIC) filter, a finite impulse response (FIR) filter, an infinite impulse response (IIR) filter, a Butterworth filter, a Chebyshev filter, an elliptic filter, etc.

(151) The frequency interpreter **146** receives the bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **148** value for the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. As an example, the frequency interpreter **146** is a processing module, or portion thereof, that executes a function to convert the first bandpass filter sensed signal into the mutual capacitance value **148**, which is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value). As another example, the frequency interpreter **146** is a look up table where the first bandpass filter sensed signal is an index for the table.

(152) For the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**, the differential drive-sense circuit **96-4** produces a second sensed signal **116-4**. The bandpass filter **150** passes, substantially unattenuated, signals in a bandpass region centered about frequency $f_{sub.4}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. In this example, the bandpass filter **150** passes the portion of the second sensed signal **116-4** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**.

(153) The frequency interpreter **152** receives the bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **154** value for the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**. In an embodiment, the mutual capacitance value **154** is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value).

(154) Referring to FIG. **21B**, the first sensed signal **116-1** includes a first frequency component at $f_{sub.1}$ that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the first and second electrodes of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1**. The third frequency component at $f_{sub.3}$ corresponds to a mutual capacitance at a crossing of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**. A fourth frequency component at $f_{sub.4}$ corresponds to a mutual capacitance at a crossing of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**. A second frequency component is not included in the sensed signal because coupling between the column differential pairs does not occur. In an embodiment, the sensed signals **116** are frequency domain digital signals.

(155) To eliminate ghost touches as discussed with reference to FIG. **20**, the processing module filters the sensed signals to extract data corresponding to cross sections of columns and row differential electrode pairs. The processing module only needs one mutual capacitance measurement per differential electrode pairs cross section so in the examples of FIGS. **21A-21B**, only the sensed signals produced by the column differential electrode pairs are filtered for cross section mutual capacitance as well as the mutual capacitance between the column differential electrode pairs. In another example, only the sensed signals produced by the row differential electrodes pairs are filtered for cross section mutual capacitance as well as the mutual capacitance between the row differential electrode pairs.

(156) The bandpass filter **136** passes (i.e., substantially unattenuated) signals in a bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency $f_{sub.1}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. As such, the first bandpass filter **136** passes the portion of the sensed signal **116-1** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c**. In an embodiment, the sensed signal **116-1** is a digital signal, thus, the first bandpass filter **136** is a digital filter such as a cascaded integrated comb (CIC) filter, a finite impulse response (FIR) filter, an infinite impulse response (IIR) filter, a Butterworth filter, a Chebyshev filter, an elliptic filter, etc.

(157) The frequency interpreter **164** receives the first bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **130** value for the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1**. As an example, the frequency interpreter **164** is a processing module, or portion thereof, that executes a function to convert the first bandpass filter sensed signal into the mutual capacitance **130** value, which is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value). As another example, the frequency interpreter **164** is a look up table where the first bandpass filter sensed signal is an index for the table.

(158) The bandpass filter **144-1** passes (i.e., substantially unattenuated) signals in a bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency $f_{sub.3}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. As such, the bandpass filter **144-1** passes the portion of the sensed signal **116-1** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the cross section of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** of FIG. 21A.

(159) The frequency interpreter **146-1** receives the bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **156** value for the cross section of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**.

(160) The bandpass filter **150-1** passes, substantially unattenuated, signals in a bandpass region centered about frequency $f_{sub.4}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. In this example, the bandpass filter **150-1** passes the portion of the first sensed signal **116-1** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the cross section of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**.

(161) The frequency interpreter **152-1** receives the bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **158** value for the cross section of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**.

(162) For the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2**, the differential drive-sense circuit **96-2** produces a second sensed signal **116-2**. The bandpass filter **138** passes, substantially unattenuated, signals in a bandpass region centered about frequency $f_{sub.2}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. In this example, the bandpass filter **138** passes the portion of the second sensed signal **116-2** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2**.

(163) The frequency interpreter **166** receives the second bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **133** value for the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2**. In an embodiment, the mutual capacitance **133** value is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value).

(164) The bandpass filter **144-2** passes (i.e., substantially unattenuated) signals in a bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency $f_{sub.3}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. As such, the bandpass filter **144-2** passes the portion of the sensed signal **116-2** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the cross section of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** of FIG. 21A.

(165) The frequency interpreter **146-2** receives the bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance value **160** for the cross section of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** of FIG. 21A.

(166) The bandpass filter **150-2** passes, substantially unattenuated, signals in a bandpass region centered about frequency $f_{sub.4}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. In this example, the bandpass filter **150-2** passes the portion of the second sensed signal **116-2** that corresponds to the mutual capacitance of the cross section of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** of FIG. 21A.

(167) The frequency interpreter **152-2** receives the bandpass filter sensed signal and interprets it to render a mutual capacitance (“cap”) **162** value for the cross section of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**.

(168) FIG. **22** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55** that includes differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) **96-1** through **96-4**, a first and second column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and **54-c2**, and a first and second row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and **54-r2**. FIG. **20** operates similarly to the no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55** of FIG. **17** and shows an example of detecting two touches and/or hovers **140-1** and **140-2** simultaneously on the no-ground plane differential touch screen display **55**. The touch and/or hover **140-1** shown causes a decrease in the mutual capacitance between a first and second electrode of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** (e.g., C.sub.m1) and a decrease in the mutual capacitance between a first and second electrode of the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** (e.g., C.sub.m3).

(169) The touch and/or hover **140-2** shown causes a decrease in the mutual capacitance between a first and second electrode of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** (e.g., C.sub.m2) and a decrease in the mutual capacitance between a first and second electrode of the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** (e.g., C.sub.m4).

(170) By identifying mutual capacitance changes at cross sections of column differential electrode pairs and row differential electrode pairs, the no-ground plane differential touch screen display can distinguish between the real touches **140-1** and **140-2** and ghost touches as discussed with reference to FIG. **20**.

(171) For example, the real touch **140-1** causes a decrease in the mutual capacitance at the cross section of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** (e.g., C.sub.m1-3 goes down). The real touch **140-2** causes a decrease in the mutual capacitance at the cross section of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** (e.g., C.sub.m2-4 goes down). Because the mutual capacitance at the cross section of the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2** and the mutual capacitance at the cross section of the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1** remain unchanged, the no-ground plane differential touch screen display can identify the location of real touches as compared to ghost touches.

(172) FIG. **23** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) **96** implementing a passive listening function. The differential drive-sense circuit (DDSC) **96** includes drive-sense circuits **60-1** and **60-2**, a 180° phase shifter **98**, and an output operational amplifier (op-amp) **100**. The DDSC **96** of FIG. **23** operates similarly to the DDSC of FIG. **9** except the DDSC **96** of FIG. **23** is fed a direct current (DC) voltage reference signal input (e.g., VREF DC) instead of an analog voltage reference signal.

(173) The drive-sense circuits **60-1** and **60-2** each include an op-amp **102-1** and **102-2**, and a regulated current source circuit **104-1** and **104-2**. Within the drive-sense circuit **60-1**, the positive input terminal of the op-amp **102-1** is coupled to a first electrode **54-1** of a differential electrode pair and the negative input terminal of the op-amp **102-1** is coupled to a voltage reference source (e.g., via a signal generator, via the processing module that generates and provides the voltage reference signal, etc.) that provides the DC voltage reference signal VREF DC. Within the drive-sense circuit **60-2**, the positive input terminal of the op-amp **102-2** is coupled to the 180° phase shifter **98**. Because VREF DC is a DC signal with no phase, the 180° phase shifter **98** provides the DC voltage reference signal VREF DC to the positive input terminal of the op-amp **102-2**. The negative input terminal of the op-amp **56-2** is coupled to a second electrode **54-2** of the differential electrode pair.

(174) The drive-sense circuits **60-1** and **60-2** operate similarly to the drive-sense circuit **60** of FIG. **3** where the feedback loops function to keep the electrode signals **76-1** and **76-2** substantially

matching the DC reference signal (VREF DC). As such, the electrode signals **76-1** and **76-2** will have a similar signal format to that of the VREF DC.

(175) In the passive listening mode, the DDSC **96** can detect AC signals in proximity to the differential touch screen display. For example, a device **174** (e.g., an active touch screen pen, an active gaming piece, any active electronic device capable of transmitting an AC signal, etc.) transmits an AC signal at a frequency f_x in proximity to the differential electrode pair **54**. The electrode signals **76-1** and **76-2** include a drive signal component and a receive signal component that includes the AC signal at a frequency f_x . The op-amp **102-1** of the drive-sense circuit **60-1** compares the electrode signal **76-1** to the VREF DC signal to produce an analog comparison signal **106-1** which includes a representation of the AC device signal.

(176) The analog comparison signal **106-1** is fed back to the regulated current source circuit **104-1** as analog feedback signal **108-1**. The regulated current source circuit **104-1** generates a regulated source signal **110-1** (e.g., a regulated current signal (I_1)) based on the analog feedback signal **108-1**. The regulated current signal (I_1) in combination with the impedance (Z) of the electrode creates a voltage (V), where $V=I*Z$. As the impedance (Z) of electrode changes, the regulated current (I) signal is adjusted to keep the voltage (V) substantially unchanged.

(177) The op-amp **102-2** of the drive-sense circuit **60-2** compares the electrode signal **76-2** to the VREF DC signal to produce an analog comparison signal **106-2** which includes a representation of the AC device signal. The analog comparison signal **106-2** is fed back to the regulated current source circuit **104-2** as analog feedback signal **108-2**. The regulated current source circuit **104-2** generates a regulated source signal **110-2** (e.g., a regulated current signal (I_2)) based on the analog feedback signal **108-2**. The regulated current signal (I_2) in combination with the impedance (Z) of the electrode creates a voltage (V), where $V=I*Z$. As the impedance (Z) of the electrode changes, the regulated current (I) signal is adjusted to keep the voltage (V) substantially unchanged.

(178) The output op-amp **100** compares the analog comparison signal **106-1** and the analog comparison signal **106-2** to produce an analog receive (RX) signal **112**. Comparing the analog comparison signal **106-1** and the analog comparison signal **106-2** doubles the AC receive components representative of the device **174** signal.

(179) FIG. **24** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a differential touch screen display **44** that includes a differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) **96-1** through **96-4**, a first and second column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and **54-c2**, and a first and second row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and **54-r2**. The DDSCs **96-1** through **96-4** operate similarly to the DDSC of FIG. **23** to provide DC reference signals **1-4** (e.g., VREF DC) to the differential electrode pairs and generate sensed signals **1-4** representative of AC signals produced by devices proximal to the differential touch screen display **44**. To produce the sensed signals **1-4**, the DDSCs **96-1** through **96-4** in this example include an ADC at the output to convert the analog reference signals to a digital sensed signal.

(180) In response to a device **174** transmitting a signal at frequency f_x proximal to the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**, the DDSC **96-1** generates a sensed signal **1** including a component at frequency f_x and the DDSC **96-3** generates a sensed signal **3** including a component at frequency f_x . Based on the frequency detection and analysis, the differential touch screen display can identify the location of the device, identity of a device, and/or an input function associated with the device. As shown, because the differential touch screen display is in a passive listening mode, touches and hovers that do not produce an AC signal are ignored. Therefore, a user can rest a hand or elbow on the display without the touch interfering with intended user inputs produced by the device **174**.

(181) FIG. **25** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of a portion of a differential touch screen display **44** that includes a differential drive-sense circuits (DDSCs) **96-1** through **96-4**, a first and second column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and **54-c2**, and a first and second row differential electrode pair **54-r1** and **54-r2**. FIG. **25** operates similarly to FIG. **24** except a plurality

of devices **1-3** are in proximity to the differential touch screen display. For example, the devices **1-3** may be game pieces associated with one or more users.

(182) In the example shown, the device **1** is proximal to the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the first row differential electrode pair **54-r1**, the device **2** is proximal to the second column differential electrode pair **54-c2** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**, and the device **3** is proximal to the first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the second row differential electrode pair **54-r2**. Device **1** transmits an AC signal at a frequency $f_{sub.1}$, device **2** transmits an AC signal at a frequency $f_{sub.2}$, and device **3** transmits an AC signal at a frequency $f_{sub.3}$.

(183) As such, the DDSC **96-1** generates a sensed signal **1** including frequency components at frequency $f_{sub.1}$ and $f_{sub.3}$, the DDSC **96-2** generates a sensed signal **2** including a frequency component at frequency $f_{sub.2}$, the DDSC **96-3** generates a sensed signal **3** including a frequency component at frequency $f_{sub.1}$, and the DDSC **96-4** generates a sensed signal **4** including frequency components at frequency $f_{sub.2}$ and $f_{sub.3}$. Based on the frequency detection and analysis, the differential touch screen display can identify the location of the devices, identity of the devices, and/or one or more input functions associated with the devices.

(184) FIG. **26** is a schematic block diagram of an embodiment of differential drive-sense circuits **96-1** and **96-2** and a portion of the touch screen processing module of a differential touch screen display. FIG. **26** includes two column differential drive-sense circuits **96-1** and **96-2** (e.g., DDSC **96-1** and **96-2** of FIG. **25**) and the portion of the processing module includes analog to digital converters (ADCs) **114-1** and **114-2** (e.g., when the DDSCs do not include ADCs), bandpass filters at frequencies $f_{sub.1}$ - $f_{sub.3}$ and frequency interpreters **176-1** & **176-2**, **178-1** & **178-2**, and **180-1** & **180-2**. The differential drive-sense circuit **96-1** is coupled to a first column differential electrode pair **54-c1** and the differential drive-sense circuit **96-2** is coupled to a second column differential electrode pair electrode **54-c2**.

(185) The differential drive-sense circuits provide electrode signals to their respective differential electrode pairs and produce therefrom respective sensed signals. Continuing the example of FIG. **25**, the sensed signal **116-1** includes frequency components $f_{sub.1}$ and $f_{sub.3}$. The first frequency component at $f_{sub.1}$ corresponds to detection of the device **1**'s transmit signal. The third frequency component at $f_{sub.3}$ corresponds to detection of the device **3**'s transmit signal. The sensed signal **116-2** includes a frequency component at $f_{sub.2}$ corresponding to detection of the device **2**'s transmit signal.

(186) The bandpass filter at $f_{sub.1}$ passes (i.e., substantially unattenuated) signals in a bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency $f_{sub.1}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. The bandpass filter at $f_{sub.2}$ passes (i.e., substantially unattenuated) signals in a bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency $f_{sub.2}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. The bandpass filter at $f_{sub.3}$ passes (i.e., substantially unattenuated) signals in a bandpass region (e.g., tens of Hertz to hundreds of thousands of Hertz, or more) centered about frequency $f_{sub.3}$ and attenuates signals outside of the bandpass region. More or less bandpass filters may be used depending on how many signals/devices need to be detected at any one time. Further, when the frequency of a device is unknown, the processing module may include one or more wideband filters for filtering a range of frequencies in an area of interest. As another example, the processing module may include a plurality of narrow band pass filters for filtering a range of frequencies in an area of interest.

(187) As such, the bandpass filter at $f_{sub.1}$ passes the portion of the sensed signal **116-1** that corresponds to device **1** detection. The bandpass filter at $f_{sub.2}$ passes the portion of the sensed signal **116-2** that corresponds to device **2** detection. The bandpass filter at $f_{sub.3}$ passes the portion of the sensed signal **116-1** that corresponds to device **3** detection. In an embodiment, the sensed signal **116-1** is a digital signal, thus, the bandpass filters are digital filters such as cascaded

integrated comb (CIC) filters, finite impulse response (FIR) filters, infinite impulse response (IIR) filters, Butterworth filters, Chebyshev filters, elliptic filters, etc.

(188) The frequency interpreters **176-180** receive the bandpass filtered sensed signals and interpret them to render device capacitance values **182-184** for the column differential electrode pairs **54-c**. As an example, the frequency interpreter **176-1** is a processing module, or portion thereof, that executes a function to convert the first bandpass filter sensed signal of the DDSC **96-1** into the device capacitance (“cap”) **182-1** value pertaining to the device **1**, which is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value). As another example, the frequency interpreter **176-1** is a look up table where the first bandpass filter sensed signal is an index for the table.

(189) The frequency interpreter **180-1** is a processing module, or portion thereof, that executes a function to convert the third bandpass filter sensed signal of the DDSC **96-1** into the device capacitance (“cap”) **186-3** value pertaining to the device **3**, which is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value). As another example, the frequency interpreter **180-1** is a look up table where the third bandpass filter sensed signal is an index for the table.

(190) The frequency interpreter **178-2** is a processing module, or portion thereof, that executes a function to convert a second bandpass filter sensed signal of the DDSC **96-2** into the device capacitance (“cap”) **184-2** value pertaining to the device **2**, which is an actual capacitance value, a relative capacitance value (e.g., in a range of 0-100), or a difference capacitance value (e.g., is the difference between a default capacitance value and a sensed capacitance value). As another example, the frequency interpreter **178-2** is a look up table where the second bandpass filter sensed signal is an index for the table.

(191) It is noted that terminologies as may be used herein such as bit stream, stream, signal sequence, etc. (or their equivalents) have been used interchangeably to describe digital information whose content corresponds to any of a number of desired types (e.g., data, video, speech, text, graphics, audio, etc. any of which may generally be referred to as ‘data’).

(192) As may be used herein, the terms “substantially” and “approximately” provides an industry-accepted tolerance for its corresponding term and/or relativity between items. For some industries, an industry-accepted tolerance is less than one percent and, for other industries, the industry-accepted tolerance is 10 percent or more. Other examples of industry-accepted tolerance range from less than one percent to fifty percent. Industry-accepted tolerances correspond to, but are not limited to, component values, integrated circuit process variations, temperature variations, rise and fall times, thermal noise, dimensions, signaling errors, dropped packets, temperatures, pressures, material compositions, and/or performance metrics. Within an industry, tolerance variances of accepted tolerances may be more or less than a percentage level (e.g., dimension tolerance of less than $\pm 1\%$). Some relativity between items may range from a difference of less than a percentage level to a few percent. Other relativity between items may range from a difference of a few percent to magnitude of differences.

(193) As may also be used herein, the term(s) “configured to”, “operably coupled to”, “coupled to”, and/or “coupling” includes direct coupling between items and/or indirect coupling between items via an intervening item (e.g., an item includes, but is not limited to, a component, an element, a circuit, and/or a module) where, for an example of indirect coupling, the intervening item does not modify the information of a signal but may adjust its current level, voltage level, and/or power level. As may further be used herein, inferred coupling (i.e., where one element is coupled to another element by inference) includes direct and indirect coupling between two items in the same manner as “coupled to”.

(194) As may even further be used herein, the term “configured to”, “operable to”, “coupled to”, or

“operably coupled to” indicates that an item includes one or more of power connections, input(s), output(s), etc., to perform, when activated, one or more its corresponding functions and may further include inferred coupling to one or more other items. As may still further be used herein, the term “associated with”, includes direct and/or indirect coupling of separate items and/or one item being embedded within another item.

(195) As may be used herein, the term “compares favorably”, indicates that a comparison between two or more items, signals, etc., provides a desired relationship. For example, when the desired relationship is that signal 1 has a greater magnitude than signal 2, a favorable comparison may be achieved when the magnitude of signal 1 is greater than that of signal 2 or when the magnitude of signal 2 is less than that of signal 1. As may be used herein, the term “compares unfavorably”, indicates that a comparison between two or more items, signals, etc., fails to provide the desired relationship.

(196) As may be used herein, one or more claims may include, in a specific form of this generic form, the phrase “at least one of a, b, and c” or of this generic form “at least one of a, b, or c”, with more or less elements than “a”, “b”, and “c”. In either phrasing, the phrases are to be interpreted identically. In particular, “at least one of a, b, and c” is equivalent to “at least one of a, b, or c” and shall mean a, b, and/or c. As an example, it means: “a” only, “b” only, “c” only, “a” and “b”, “a” and “c”, “b” and “c”, and/or “a”, “b”, and “c”.

(197) As may also be used herein, the terms “processing module”, “processing circuit”, “processor”, “processing circuitry”, and/or “processing unit” may be a single processing device or a plurality of processing devices. Such a processing device may be a microprocessor, micro-controller, digital signal processor, microcomputer, central processing unit, field programmable gate array, programmable logic device, state machine, logic circuitry, analog circuitry, digital circuitry, and/or any device that manipulates signals (analog and/or digital) based on hard coding of the circuitry and/or operational instructions. The processing module, module, processing circuit, processing circuitry, and/or processing unit may be, or further include, memory and/or an integrated memory element, which may be a single memory device, a plurality of memory devices, and/or embedded circuitry of another processing module, module, processing circuit, processing circuitry, and/or processing unit. Such a memory device may be a read-only memory, random access memory, volatile memory, non-volatile memory, static memory, dynamic memory, flash memory, cache memory, and/or any device that stores digital information. Note that if the processing module, module, processing circuit, processing circuitry, and/or processing unit includes more than one processing device, the processing devices may be centrally located (e.g., directly coupled together via a wired and/or wireless bus structure) or may be distributedly located (e.g., cloud computing via indirect coupling via a local area network and/or a wide area network).

Further note that if the processing module, module, processing circuit, processing circuitry and/or processing unit implements one or more of its functions via a state machine, analog circuitry, digital circuitry, and/or logic circuitry, the memory and/or memory element storing the corresponding operational instructions may be embedded within, or external to, the circuitry comprising the state machine, analog circuitry, digital circuitry, and/or logic circuitry. Still further note that, the memory element may store, and the processing module, module, processing circuit, processing circuitry and/or processing unit executes, hard coded and/or operational instructions corresponding to at least some of the steps and/or functions illustrated in one or more of the Figures. Such a memory device or memory element can be included in an article of manufacture.

(198) One or more embodiments have been described above with the aid of method steps illustrating the performance of specified functions and relationships thereof. The boundaries and sequence of these functional building blocks and method steps have been arbitrarily defined herein for convenience of description. Alternate boundaries and sequences can be defined so long as the specified functions and relationships are appropriately performed. Any such alternate boundaries or sequences are thus within the scope and spirit of the claims. Further, the boundaries of these

functional building blocks have been arbitrarily defined for convenience of description. Alternate boundaries could be defined as long as the certain significant functions are appropriately performed. Similarly, flow diagram blocks may also have been arbitrarily defined herein to illustrate certain significant functionality.

(199) To the extent used, the flow diagram block boundaries and sequence could have been defined otherwise and still perform the certain significant functionality. Such alternate definitions of both functional building blocks and flow diagram blocks and sequences are thus within the scope and spirit of the claims. One of average skill in the art will also recognize that the functional building blocks, and other illustrative blocks, modules and components herein, can be implemented as illustrated or by discrete components, application specific integrated circuits, processors executing appropriate software and the like or any combination thereof.

(200) In addition, a flow diagram may include a “start” and/or “continue” indication. The “start” and “continue” indications reflect that the steps presented can optionally be incorporated in or otherwise used in conjunction with one or more other routines. In addition, a flow diagram may include an “end” and/or “continue” indication. The “end” and/or “continue” indications reflect that the steps presented can end as described and shown or optionally be incorporated in or otherwise used in conjunction with one or more other routines. In this context, “start” indicates the beginning of the first step presented and may be preceded by other activities not specifically shown. Further, the “continue” indication reflects that the steps presented may be performed multiple times and/or may be succeeded by other activities not specifically shown. Further, while a flow diagram indicates a particular ordering of steps, other orderings are likewise possible provided that the principles of causality are maintained.

(201) The one or more embodiments are used herein to illustrate one or more aspects, one or more features, one or more concepts, and/or one or more examples. A physical embodiment of an apparatus, an article of manufacture, a machine, and/or of a process may include one or more of the aspects, features, concepts, examples, etc. described with reference to one or more of the embodiments discussed herein. Further, from figure to figure, the embodiments may incorporate the same or similarly named functions, steps, modules, etc. that may use the same or different reference numbers and, as such, the functions, steps, modules, etc. may be the same or similar functions, steps, modules, etc. or different ones.

(202) Unless specifically stated to the contra, signals to, from, and/or between elements in a figure of any of the figures presented herein may be analog or digital, continuous time or discrete time, and single-ended or differential. For instance, if a signal path is shown as a single-ended path, it also represents a differential signal path. Similarly, if a signal path is shown as a differential path, it also represents a single-ended signal path. While one or more particular architectures are described herein, other architectures can likewise be implemented that use one or more data buses not expressly shown, direct connectivity between elements, and/or indirect coupling between other elements as recognized by one of average skill in the art.

(203) The term “module” is used in the description of one or more of the embodiments. A module implements one or more functions via a device such as a processor or other processing device or other hardware that may include or operate in association with a memory that stores operational instructions. A module may operate independently and/or in conjunction with software and/or firmware. As also used herein, a module may contain one or more sub-modules, each of which may be one or more modules.

(204) As may further be used herein, a computer readable memory includes one or more memory elements. A memory element may be a separate memory device, multiple memory devices, or a set of memory locations within a memory device. Such a memory device may be a read-only memory, random access memory, volatile memory, non-volatile memory, static memory, dynamic memory, flash memory, cache memory, a quantum register or other quantum memory and/or any other device that stores data in a non-transitory manner. Furthermore, the memory device may be in a

form of a solid-state memory, a hard drive memory or other disk storage, cloud memory, thumb drive, server memory, computing device memory, and/or other non-transitory medium for storing data. The storage of data includes temporary storage (i.e., data is lost when power is removed from the memory element) and/or persistent storage (i.e., data is retained when power is removed from the memory element). As used herein, a transitory medium shall mean one or more of: (a) a wired or wireless medium for the transportation of data as a signal from one computing device to another computing device for temporary storage or persistent storage; (b) a wired or wireless medium for the transportation of data as a signal within a computing device from one element of the computing device to another element of the computing device for temporary storage or persistent storage; (c) a wired or wireless medium for the transportation of data as a signal from one computing device to another computing device for processing the data by the other computing device; and (d) a wired or wireless medium for the transportation of data as a signal within a computing device from one element of the computing device to another element of the computing device for processing the data by the other element of the computing device. As may be used herein, a non-transitory computer readable memory is substantially equivalent to a computer readable memory. A non-transitory computer readable memory can also be referred to as a non-transitory computer readable storage medium.

(205) While particular combinations of various functions and features of the one or more embodiments have been expressly described herein, other combinations of these features and functions are likewise possible. The present disclosure is not limited by the particular examples disclosed herein and expressly incorporates these other combinations.

Claims

1. A differential drive sense circuit comprises: a non-inverting section operable for coupling to a non-inverting electrode of a differential electrode, wherein the non-inverting section includes: a first operational amplifier; a first dependent current source; and a first feedback circuit, wherein the first feedback circuit provides a first feedback signal to an input of the first dependent current source, wherein: the first feedback signal is based on a first output voltage of the first operational amplifier, the first dependent current source generates a first dependent current based on the first feedback signal, a first input of the first operational amplifier is coupled to an output of the first dependent current source and to the non-inverting electrode, the first dependent current is sourced to the non-inverting electrode, a second input of the first operational amplifier is coupled to receive a non-inverting reference signal that includes an AC component, and the first operational amplifier adjusts the first output to regulate a voltage on the first input of the first operational amplifier to substantially matches a voltage of the non-inverting reference signal; an inverting section operable for coupling to a non-inverting electrode of a differential electrode, wherein the non-inverting section includes: a second operational amplifier; a second dependent current source; and a second feedback circuit, wherein the second feedback circuit provides a second feedback signal to an input of the second dependent current source, wherein: the second feedback signal is based on a second output voltage of the second operational amplifier, the second dependent current source generates a second dependent current based on the second feedback signal, a first input of the second operational amplifier is coupled to an output of the second dependent current source and to the non-inverting electrode, the second dependent current is sourced to the non-inverting electrode, a second input of the second operational amplifier is coupled to receive an inverting reference signal that includes an AC component, and the second operational amplifier adjusts the second output to regulate a voltage on the second input of the second operational amplifier to substantially match a voltage of the non-inverting reference signal.
